

Wednesday, August 3

Peter is finding more to enjoy. He listens, follows the instructions, relaxes when given the chance, has the confidence to participate in his own right. Once Matthew does wake, he wants to ride the elevator. He rocks his chair to get near the door for when it opens. He also wants Cheryl. Whenever we walk by the room she is in he tries to crawl to her over my shoulder.

We ate lunch at Joe's Diner where plate trays and sandwiches are taken from a '57 Chevy. Cheryl and I shared a hamburger and fries. Peter ate a hot-fudge sundae. When we saw a toy store Peter remembered yesterday's gun, but every passion has its tombstone. He rode off into the sunset with a nerf spring-loaded race car. Once at home, Peter and Cheryl napped. Matthew and I kept each other company on Michael's loveseat. He bounced, and when one leg slipped behind the springs he pulled at my shirt to free himself. Then he kneeled at the spot, pushed his hand as deep as it could go, and looked up at me. He puffed. At that age, suddenly losing a leg is an adventure. He slept shortly after. We left by 2:30.

During Peter's theory lesson, Matthew and I strolled around the campus. The sun was hot, so we alternated the outside with the cool hallways. Then Cheryl and Peter joined us outside where Peter practised. He is tired. At 4 Cheryl and I went to a parent's session and listened to explanations of the objects of the program's many games. Peter sat with us, fiddling with the lift-top of a desk. Matthew stayed with a babysitter. We picked him up at 5. He was in his stroller at the corner with children screaming all around him. He was tired and wet from a leaky bottle of milk.

We met Michael for supper at Humpty's Egg Place on McLeod Trail. Cheryl and I split a cheddar-cheese omelet (the thinnest three eggs I can remember), and Peter had a hamburger. We picked up Cathy and went to Market Mall. The plan for the movie went through, and Cheryl, Matthew and I shopped (a keystone, Peter's name stamp, a dot-to-dot, groceries). Going home we detoured through the vices of the 14th Ave and 7th St neighbourhood and found a tired Michael and Cathy who had been through the Peter-wringer of Snow White questions.

They leave tomorrow for a Chevron flight over the Rockies. Lunch in Jasper. Peter told us his dream.

"Cathy was crying. We were in the bedroom when she came. Michael asked, "'Why are you crying? We're just doing something in the bedroom.' But she still cried. She was still in tears."

Thursday August 4

Two classes in the morning, two in the afternoon. Peter listens more carefully to his teachers than to us. Hmm. At noon we drive home. Several driving errors were committed that have probably found their way into a parallel journal: passing the 6th street turnoff and turning into a one-way street on 2nd, driving further than necessary.... More groceries. Peter is wild. He bounces around, races at Matthew, talks loud all the time. After lunch I took Peter to the Bonzai Water Slides. We paid the \$8, undressed in public, and slid until 1. The bobsledding position worked best. With Peter lying flat on me we flew high around the tight curves with someone always close behind. Only when a down-syndrome teenage boy followed even more closely than the others did we risk a violent outcome. Just as we reached the bottom I threw Peter clear. He came up sputtering, surprised, and asked if we could that again. Back at the condo there was an emotional cello practise, then a return to the university. Michael met us there after returning from his trip over the mountains. He was sleepy with nausea.

We had a barbeque on Michael's new Hibachi. Cathy brought wine which we drank from sugar bowls. Matthew clapped to the rhythm of Simon and Garfunkel. When the music stopped he kept on, periodically, for the rest of the day. Michael and I went to a music store, Cheryl put the tired boys to bed, Cathy went home. We were back by 9. Michael biked with Cathy. The boys had been sleeping for an hour. Cheryl and I talked about the day and went to bed at 10. I thought of Matthew earlier that day, sitting in the strong breeze, with hair flying, his arms raised, and a call deep from within that sounded maybe like Elijah the prophet when he was a boy.

Friday August 5

Peter's final day. Good. Cheryl and I are rather tired of pushing him, and Peter has come to the end of being pushed. The days have been long, and Peter is dying to be free. Tomorrow we will drive to Banff.

We were late getting to the university. Peter talked the whole way about getting fired from jobs. I wheeled Matthew all over campus, first to the main foyer under the stairs, then to the Food-For-Thought cafeteria to add to the journal and drink coffee, then to the theatre hallway, and finally to a bench under the trees in the middle of the campus with Pluto wrapping his rubber legs around Matthew's arm. We had lunch downtown at the Express Cafe. We went along Stanley Street to the 'Catch the Wind' toy and game shop. We spent \$149 on presents, which included physics and chemistry sets for Peter. Cheryl left with the boys while I paid to listen to a rag band on the sidewalk. An old woman in pink shorts and sunglasses danced alone in the clearing and sucked on a long string of beads. The afternoon was abbreviated, we had a large supper of Japanese noodles and ground meat, then returned to the university by 7 for Peter's concert.

Peter was excited. The room was full. The program began with three baroque orchestra pieces, then a younger reading orchestra, then the cellos. It looks as if Peter has learned a lot. Matthew thinks so. He clapped with every piece. The violins played two short concertos by Bach and Vivaldi. The pieces became easier as more violinists came on stage. We left before the finish to get Michael's key before going out with Cathy. Following the Rider-Eskimo game, we went for ice-cream at My Favourite Ice-Cream Shoppe. We meant to go next to the large reservoir on 20th St. SW, but the boys were asleep, and we were home by 11.

Saturday August 6

We left with Michael and Cathy for Banff by 10. Peter sat in the back and led a conversation about births. He talks and questions even when the answers he gets have no particular focus or meaning. He's a Pandora's Box of inquiry. The day was warm and clear. We were there by 11:20, and parked on Banff Avenue. We shopped for food for Matthew, were greeted at Samo's Broiler by a Grecian statue with a cardboard "Please Wait to be Seated" sign around its neck. A good meal but Matthew posed his usual challenges. Michael and Cathy went off to hike on Rundle's lower slopes, and we drove by the Douglas Fir Chalets on Tunnel Mountain where we honeymooned to discover that the quaint cabins with

flower boxes, varnished interior and fireplace had been replaced by A-frames. We found a viewing spot over the Bow River valley. Peter and I sat on a stone. Cheryl tried for a photo of Peter with his arm around my neck, but no more film. We visited the Luxton Indian Museum, and for \$4 we spent 90 minutes with Peter asking how animals were killed, what the sun dance was about, and the Buffalo hunt, etc, and pulled Matthew off the fragile displays. Then it was a drive up Sulphur Mountain, back into Banff for ice-cream, and up Spray Avenue to the Bow Falls. Cheryl waited at the car with a sleeping Matthew, and Peter and I threw stones into the river. When Michael and Cathy returned, we went to the Golf Chalet, studied the dress regulations, and crossed the wooden bridge to the Banff Springs Hotel. Peter had punched a button on a Coke machine and got a free drink. We bypassed the outdoor and indoor pools, toured the lobby and mezzanine floors, viewed \$1,000 rings, and watched people go by. Matthew was in a pack on my back. Peter ran about. We took an elevator to the top, peeked into open rooms on the 6th and 7th, listened to a tour-guide give information about the mushroom staircase and its handrails polished twice daily, and circled inside a medieval banquet room on a dimly lighted balcony floor. We left Banff by 5 in time for Cathy to see her parents after their visit with her brother in Traill. We ate the rest of yesterday's Japanese noodles and then packed. The boys were dressed for bed when Cathy phoned inviting us over. We visited with her parents and drank tea for a half hour. Michael came home with us. The boys went to bed, Cheryl read, and Michael and I talked more about guitars.

Sunday August 7

It's home today. We packed up our things that were scattered across Michael's condominium and left by 9. On the way to Kindersley Peter played dot-to-dot and yo-yo, and Matthew ate, clowned with wrinkled nose, and slept. We ate in Kindersley at the Gulf Station restaurant, listened to the locals talk, bought revels, gassed up, were off by 2:30 and home by 4:30. The air was hot.

Cheryl phoned her parents, but Peter spent most of the time with them. We unpacked, washed the car and drove to their place. We went to the Sheraton Cavalier for supper, exchanged news, then walked in Kiwanis Park until the mosquitoes chased us back to the car. Peter shot Papa's finger with a toy rifle and colored in a book with magic effects (the colour isn't apparent because it is dried on the page and activates when the special pen is used). Matthew walked

across the floor between a pitcher and whoever would catch him. He attempted to clap, walk, snort and laugh at the same time, two steps ahead, one back, one ahead, two sideways, freeze, fall.

We returned home by 9, watched Fawlty Towers (the rat and the Health Inspector), put Peter to bed with a Suzuki tape. All Matthew needs yet is our patience.

Cheryl and I were in bed by 10:30.